April 19, 2026

The Editor
The R Journal

Dear Editor,

Please consider the article *climatekit: Unified Climate Indices for Temperature, Precipitation, and Drought in R* for publication in the R Journal.

The article introduces the `climatekit` package, which consolidates thirty climate indicators behind a single consistent interface. Until now, the R ecosystem has exposed parts of this analysis piecemeal: separate packages for drought indices (`SPEI`), for ETCCDI climate-change indices (`climdex.pcic`, archived), for fire weather (`cffdrs`), and for various agroclimatic indicators. `climatekit` brings the full set of temperature, precipitation, drought, agroclimatic, and thermal-comfort indicators into one package with a tidy-data-frame output format that composes directly across families. The package is pure R, has no network dependency, and is already on CRAN.

Readers of the R Journal who work in applied climate analysis, agricultural research, insurance, or public health will find an immediate use for the package. The case study in the paper applies it to seventy-five years of real NOAA Global Historical Climatology Network Daily data from the New York Central Park station, recovering well-known climate signals including the 1960s Northeast drought and the multi-decade trend in frost days, in a handful of lines of code.

The manuscript has not been published in a peer-reviewed journal, is not currently under review elsewhere, and all rights to submit rest with the sole author.

Regards,

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